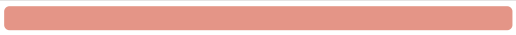
Competitor watch · Q3 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q3 2026 trading update**	**823.3 EUR**	**+6.6%**	**+13.0%**	**13.8%**	**+130 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q3 2026 trading update	–	+3.0%	+2.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q3 2026 results	2,201 USD	−3.0%	0.0%	23.9%	+70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q3 2026 results	4,695 USD	+12.7%	+7.0%	19.6%	+70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	Q3 2026 results — due 4 Nov 2026						
Emerson*	Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026)	4,873 USD	+7.0%	+6.0%	28.5%	+140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q3 2026 results	976.0 USD	−4.5%	−5.0%	24.8%	−90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						

Reported margin comparison

Aalberts		**13.8%** +130 bps EBITA margin
IMI	no margin disclosed	
Belimo	no report	
Xylem		**23.9%** +70 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab		**19.6%** +70 bps Organic operating margin
Watts	not published yet	
Emerson*		**28.5%** +140 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair		**24.8%** −90 bps Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report	

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · Q3 2026 trading update

Revenue **823.3** EUR m (+6.6% reported) · Organic growth **+13.0%** · EBITA margin **13.8%** +130 bps

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	387.2	−0.6%	+9.3%	12.1% (10.8%)	Mixed by region and product line. North America strong, especially valves, with a growing data-centre order book; Europe mixed, residential low, connection systems still under margin pressure.
Industry	238.3	−15.0%	+8.6%	19.1% (17.7%)	Growth supported by business development and geographical expansion; strong demand in aerospace, power generation and defence, stable automotive.
Semicon	201.2	+86.6%	+34.1%	15.5% (13.2%)	Growth accelerated and was higher than expected; capacity ramped up in Europe and Southeast Asia.

Segment growth: All three segments improved organic growth and EBITA margin. Semicon +34.1% organic (revenue nearly doubled, EBITA 31.2 vs 14.2, margin 15.5%) on accelerating AI-related demand. Building +9.3% organic and margin 12.1% (+130 bps), but revenue −2.2m after divestments. Industry +8.6% organic, margin 19.1% (+140 bps); revenue −42.0m from divestments.

Outlook: Entering Q4 with positive momentum and a healthy order book; confident of a full year with improved organic growth and EBITA margin versus 2025.

Source: Q3 2026 press release (PDF, 22 Oct 2026) · Press release (web)

IMI · Q3 2026 trading update

Revenue not reported in this update · Organic growth **+2.0%** · Process Automation orders **+19%** (organic in Q3; +14% YTD (excl. Truflo Marine))

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	–	–	−3.0%		Year to date +2%
Process Automation	–	–	−6.0%		Shipment timing; YTD +1%. Orders +19% in Q3; YTD new construction +27%, aftermarket +7%
Industrial Automation	–	–	+2.0%		YTD +4%
Life Technology	–	–	+11.0%		Year to date +7%
Climate Control	–	–	+13.0%		YTD +7%; data-centre orders £25m YTD (£9m)
Life Science & Fluid Control	–	–	+2.0%		YTD +4%
Transport	–	–	+19.0%		YTD +10%; FY now high-single-digit; strategic review ongoing

Segment growth: Life Technology +11% organic, with Transport +19% (truck market recovery) and Climate Control +13% (data-centre shipments). Automation −3%: Process Automation −6% on shipment timing against +26% last year, while its orders rose 19%. Group +2% against a +12% comparator; +4% year to date.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. basic EPS raised to 137p–143p (136p–142p), mainly Truflo Marine's extra contribution before its Q4 disposal and stronger Transport. 2027: net interest ~£23m, ~231m shares.

Source: Q3 2026 trading update (PDF) · Q3 2026 trading update (web)

Xylem · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **2,201** USD m (−3.0% reported) · Organic growth **0.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **23.9%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.42** (+4% vs $1.37; excl. $0.11 tariff-refund benefit) · Adj. free cash flow, year to date **444** (462 a year earlier) · Orders **2,331** (+10% organic; +7% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	645.0	−1.7%	−1.0%	26.2% (24.4%)	Orders 675 (-1% organic); Treatment softness offset by Transport
Applied Water	489.0	+7.2%	+9.0%	21.3% (21.7%)	Orders 502 (+15% organic); NA data centres and commercial; Americas revenue growth
Measurement & Control Solutions	436.0	−16.5%	−5.0%	24.5% (21.8%)	Orders 504 (+30% organic); Electric metering and analytics down; international metrology divested May 2026
Water Solutions & Services	631.0	−0.5%	−2.0%	24.9% (26.3%)	Orders 650 (+6% organic); Prior-year one-off services and capital work did not repeat

Segment growth: Orders +10% organic (MCS +30% on water and gas meters, AW +15% on NA data centres) but revenue flat: MCS −5% (electric metering, affordability), WSS −2%, WI −1%; AW +9%. Margins up in MCS (+270 bps) and WI (+180 bps), down in AW (−40) and WSS (−140).

Outlook: FY 2026 cut: revenue ~USD 8.95bn (−1%), organic flat, adj. EBITDA margin ~23.2% (+100 bps), adj. EPS $5.40–5.45 ($5.55–5.70), FCF margin ~10.2%. Q4: revenue ~USD 2.3bn, margin ~24.5%.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF) · Q3 2026 earnings release

Ecolab · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **4,695** USD m (+12.7% reported) · Organic growth **+7.0%** · Organic operating margin **19.6%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$2.18** (+5%; GAAP $1.95; ~10 pts CoolIT drag)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	2,480	+20.3%	+9.0%	18.0% (17.4%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+8.0%		
Heavy Water	–	–	+4.0%		
High-Tech	–	–	+63.0%		+293% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Light Water	–	–	+5.0%		
Paper	–	–	+6.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,638	+2.7%	+3.0%	24.7% (23.6%)	
Institutional	–	–	+2.0%		
Specialty	–	–	+5.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	363.5	+9.3%	+8.0%	20.3% (20.9%)	
Global Life Sciences	215.8	+16.5%	+17.0%	23.3% (18.3%)	

Segment growth: Organic growth accelerated to 7%: High-Tech +63% organic (+293% with Ovivo and CoolIT), Life Sciences +17%, Pest +8%, Water +9%; Institutional & Specialty +3%. Life Sciences OI +49% (margin 23.3%); Water OI +24% at fixed rates.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS $8.10–8.20 (+8% to 9%); Q4 $2.13–2.23 with reported sales +12% to 14%; 20% adj. OI margin in 2027.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Emerson* · Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026)

Revenue **4,873** USD m (+7.0% reported) · Underlying growth **+6.0%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **28.5%** +140 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.71** (+13% vs $1.52) · Free cash flow **1,323** (+36%; margin 27.1%) · Underlying orders **+7%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Software & Systems	1,644	+11.1%	+11.0%	31.8% (32.1%)	
Control Systems & Software	1,199	+7.1%	+7.0%		Strong demand in power (Ovation)
Test & Measurement	445.0	+23.6%	+23.0%		Semiconductor, aerospace & defence
Intelligent Devices	2,677	+5.6%	+5.0%	27.9% (25.5%)	
Sensors	1,091	+7.7%	+7.0%		Power and LNG in the Americas
Final Control	1,586	+4.2%	+3.0%		AMEA and Americas, power
Safety & Productivity	552.0	+2.6%	+2.0%	21.2% (20.4%)	
REGIONS					
Americas	2,537	+8.4%	+8.0%		US +10%
Asia, Middle East & Africa	1,475	+8.8%	+8.0%		China −3%
Europe	861.0	+0.6%	−1.0%		

Segment growth: Underlying +6%: Software & Systems +11% (Test & Measurement +23%), Intelligent Devices +5% with margin +240 bps to 27.9%, Safety & Productivity +2%. Americas and AMEA +8%, Europe −1%. Adj. EBITA includes no IEEPA refund (USD 82m excluded).

Outlook: FY 2026 raised: net sales ~+5%, underlying ~+3.5%, adj. EPS ~$6.55, FCF ~USD 3.6bn, adj. segment EBITA margin ~28%.

Source: Q3 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q3 2026 results

Revenue **976.0** USD m (−4.5% reported) · Core sales growth **−5.0%** · Adj. return on sales **24.8%** −90 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.18** (−5%, above $1.05–1.08 guidance; GAAP $0.91) · Free cash flow **153** (179 in Q3 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	262.0	+4.0%	+1.0%	26.2% (23.7%)	
Water Solutions	422.0	+1.0%	–	28.7% (25.0%)	Includes ~USD 6m of tariff refunds
Pool	291.0	−18.0%	−18.0%	24.6% (32.8%)	Channel destock now completed

Segment growth: Flow (+4%, core +1%) and Water Solutions (+1%) both lifted segment income ~15% with return on sales up 250 and 370 bps. Pool −18% with income −38% as the channel destock ended; management targets ~30% Pool return on sales in 2027.

Outlook: FY 2026: sales ~−3%, adj. operating income ~−6%, adj. EPS ~$4.70 (−4%); Q4: sales +7–9% incl. Taco, adj. EPS ~$1.15; FCF >100% of net income.

Source: Q3 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Other key competitors (relevance to HFC 1–5)

Bell & Gossett (Xylem) · relevance 4/5 (high)

Xylem (NYSE: XYL), Applied Water segment · revenue Applied Water segment USD 1,849m (2025) · FTEs n/d (part of Xylem)

- **Performance:** Applied Water Q3 2026: revenue USD 489m (+9% organic), orders +15% on North American data centres and commercial buildings. [Xylem Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF)]
- **M&A:** Xylem plans to divest AW International (Europe, MEA, APAC) and Specialty Flow Control; AW Americas (Bell & Gossett) joins the new Flow Solutions segment from 1 Jan 2027. [Xylem Q3 2026 earnings package (PDF)]

Taco Comfort Solutions · relevance 4/5 (high)

Pentair (NYSE: PNR) since 1 Oct 2026; previously family-owned · revenue ~USD 560m (2026e, Pentair) · FTEs n/d (estimates 350–1,000)

- **Performance:** Taco expected 2026 sales of ~USD 560m (growth >10%), above Pentair's previous expectation; Pentair expects EPS accretion in 2027. [Pentair Q3 2026 presentation (PDF)]
- **M&A:** Pentair agreed (28 Jul 2026) to acquire Taco Group Holdings for ~USD 1.4bn; closed 1 Oct 2026. Pentair cites hydronic and data-centre HVAC exposure (schools, hospitals, commercial buildings). [Taco press release · Pentair Q3 2026 presentation (PDF)]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Lubbock, Texas site earned two industry certifications (Aug 2026); new owner committed to keeping a major presence in Cranston. [RI News Today]

Armstrong Fluid Technology · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Armstrong family) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Showcased HVAC and intelligent fluid-flow solutions at BEX Asia, Singapore (Sep 2026). [Trade Arabia]

Siemens Smart Infrastructure* · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Listed (Siemens AG), segment · revenue ~EUR 23bn run-rate (FY 2026 quarters) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Fiscal Q3 2026: orders EUR 8.0bn (+42%, record), revenue EUR 6.4bn (+13% comparable), profit EUR 1.3bn (20.0%); backlog EUR 23.7bn; FY 2026 outlook raised to +10–11% revenue, 18.5–19.5% margin. [Siemens Q3 FY2026 release (PDF)]

Wilo · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Wilo-Foundation) · revenue EUR 1,918.7m (2025) · FTEs ~9,000 (2025)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Established Wilo Japan (Aug 2026), targeting data centres. [MONOist]

Alfa Laval · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (Nasdaq Stockholm: ALFA) · revenue SEK 52.6bn (9M 2026) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Q3 2026: record order intake SEK 23.2bn (+33% organic), net sales SEK 18.6bn (~+6% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1% (18.4%); data-centre orders ~SEK 2bn in the quarter. [Alfa Laval Q3 2026 report · Investing.com]

Resideo (Honeywell Home) · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (NYSE: REZI) · revenue USD 7.5bn (2025, incl. ADI) · FTEs ~14,600 (data aggregator)

- **M&A:** Completed the separation of ADI (distribution) on 3 Aug 2026; standalone Q3 guide USD 705–730m revenue; Q3 results due 10 Nov 2026. [MarketBeat]

Victaulic · relevance 2/5 (low)

Private · revenue ~USD 5.1bn (2026, IBISWorld estimate) · FTEs n/d

- **M&A:** Acquired Arumani to expand European modular construction and mechanical assemblies (Aug 2026); Core Pipe Products reported as acquired (Sep 2026, unconfirmed). [finanznachrichten.de · Signalbase]

No dated public information found for this period: Caleffi (5), Danfoss (5), Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) (5), Grundfos (4), Oventrop (4), Spirotech (4), ADEY (3), Cetetherm (3), ESBE (3), Fernox (3), Frese (3), Giacomini (3), HERZ Armaturen (3), PAW (3), PEWO Energietechnik (3), Wessels Company (3), Zilmet (3), VRF / refrigerant-based & all-electric systems (2).

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).